

Religion and Morality — Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

MASTER OVERVIEW + SOURCE MAP

How to use this companion

Syllabus scope: Philosophy of Religion. This companion visually consolidates every substantive teaching point in the learner-v2 Basic session, the complete Optional Advanced block and the consolidated register notes. Verified PYQs and original practice are retained as demand routes and answer spines; full solved-practice prose is intentionally not duplicated.

RELIGION AND MORALITY: FOUR RELATIONS



STAGE 1	Separate four religion–morality relations
STAGE 2	Reconstruct and test divine command theory
STAGE 3	Use both horns of Euthyphro
STAGE 4	Explain Kantian autonomy and heteronomy
STAGE 5	Compare modified DCT and natural law
STAGE 6	Ground ethics through dharma (moral-religious duty and order), karma (action and moral causation), Buddhism, Jainism and Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)
STAGE 7	Separate justification from “all the time” motivation
STAGE 8	Analyse religiosity as morally conditional
STAGE 9	Test arguments for religious violence
STAGE 10	Explain Nietzsche’s linked critique of religion and morality
STAGE 11	Build 10/15/20-mark answers

Topic-specific visual gateway from the learner-v2 source.

COMPANION COVERAGE ARCHITECTURE

NO SUBSTANTIVE COMPRESSION

BASIC

70 source blocksDefinitions → core doctrines → thinkers → comparisons → traps

OPTIONAL ADVANCED

199 source blocksArguments → presuppositions → objections/replies → refinements

PYQ ROUTES

17 verified/original routesDemand decoding → named evidence → scoring spine

REGISTER NOTES

59 source blocksFinal retrieval sequence → traps → bounded verdict

UNIVERSAL PAPER-II ANSWER SPINE

Answer-writing master flow: DEFINE the contested term → STATE the central thesis → RECONSTRUCT the strongest argument with a named thinker/tradition → TEST the best objection → GIVE the reply or cost → COMPARE a rival route → END with a bounded verdict.

SOURCE DISCIPLINE

Source caution: quotation attributions, doxographic reports, cross-topic ownership notes and inference labels are preserved. A route map identifies where practice belongs; it is not a claim that an independent model answer is an official UPSC key.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CORE DEFINITIONS + DOCTRINES + THINKERS

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

Canonical owner §§0–7	Basic Learning Session	Dependence, autonomy, interaction, Euthyphro, Kant, dharma (moral-religious duty and order), parity bench and answer skeletons retained
Canonical owner §§9–19	Optional Advanced	Complete doctrine dossiers, violence analysis, religiosity, motivation, Nietzsche and factual discipline retained
Audited PYQ ledger	PYQs and Answer Practice	All eleven owner questions retained with exact wording and full solutions
Premium diagnostic set	MCQs / Remediation	Forty core and eight remedial questions retained with strict answer rotation
Original practice	PYQs and Answer Practice	Six non-PYQ solved models retained
Consolidated register	Final section	A–L retrieval framework preserves complete answer logic

Visible learning labels. The four relations—conceptual grounding, epistemic access, motivation and sociological influence—are CORE PAPER II. DCT, Euthyphro, Kantian autonomy, modified DCT, natural law, dharma (moral-religious duty and order)/karma (action and moral causation) and non-theistic ethics are CORE ANSWER. Religious violence, role-dharma criticism and religiosity orientations are PYQ-TRIGGERED CORE. Evolutionary debunking is OPTIONAL ADVANCED.

What not to over-study. Do not reduce the topic to “religion teaches morality.” Do not merge justification with motivation or causal influence with logical dependence. Violence questions require argument-premise analysis, not histories of conflict. Nietzsche requires both the death-of-God diagnosis and genealogy of morality.

Learning roadmap

1	Separate four religion–morality relations
2	Reconstruct and test divine command theory
3	Use both horns of Euthyphro
4	Explain Kantian autonomy and heteronomy

5	Compare modified DCT and natural law
6	Ground ethics through dharma (moral-religious duty and order), karma (action and moral causation), Buddhism, Jainism and Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)
7	Separate justification from "all the time" motivation
8	Analyse religiosity as morally conditional
9	Test arguments for religious violence
10	Explain Nietzsche's linked critique of religion and morality
11	Build 10/15/20-mark answers

Contemporary India anchor — constitutional morality and religious practice [SUPPORTING]

[FACT] Fact: Reporting on the 2026 Sabarimala review hearings describes the Supreme Court's renewed examination of equality, religious freedom, essential religious practices and constitutional morality. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Inference: The controversy illustrates the owner's interaction thesis: morality may be shaped by religion, while public moral principles may also criticise religious practices. It does not by itself settle the philosophical question whether morality is grounded in religion. Live source checked: Mathrubhumi English, 2026 report on the Sabarimala review hearings.

Visual gateway — identify the relation before arguing

RIGHTNESS: Is an act right because God commands it?
KNOWLEDGE: Do agents need revelation to know duty?
MOTIVATION: Does God/religion make agents comply?
INFLUENCE: Does religiosity improve actual conduct?

Logical dependence != epistemic access != motivation != causal correlation

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP [INFERENCE / CAUTION]



KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

[MNEMONIC] Mnemonic — "Depend / Detach / Dialogue": morality depends on religion (Divine Command), detaches from it (Kant/secular), or dialogues with it (interaction). The Euthyphro splits the dependence view.

1. THE DEPENDENCE VIEW — morality needs religion [FACT]

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (Recommended opening definition): The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.

- "One can have morality without religion but not religion without morality" (2022 PYQ): [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

- Morality without religion is possible — secular ethics (Kant, utilitarianism, humanism) grounds morality in reason/consequences, not God. → the asymmetry.

- Divine Command Theory (DCT): an act is right because God commands it; morality is grounded in, and motivated by, God's will. Without God, the view argues, the ultimate authority of moral obligation becomes difficult to explain. [FACT]



- Religion without morality is impossible — every religion prescribes an ethic; a religion sanctioning cruelty is a contradiction. Morality is internal to religion.



- "Must normative principles reference God to create obligation?" (2025 PYQ): DCT says yes; but Kant shows autonomy can ground obligation without God. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

2. THE INDEPENDENCE VIEW — autonomous morality [FACT]

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Moral obligation can be grounded independently in reason, welfare, virtue, human dignity or the reduction of suffering, even when religion strengthens motivation.

- Horn 1 (good because commanded) → morality is arbitrary (God could command cruelty and it'd be "good").

- Kant: morality rests on reason & autonomy (the categorical imperative), not on God's command. Religion is related to morality, while God, freedom and immortality function as practical postulates rather than the source of the moral law. [FACT]

- Euthyphro dilemma (Plato): Is the pious loved by the gods because it is pious, or pious because it is loved? [FACT]



- Horn 2 (commanded because good) → goodness is independent of God (God recognises a standard He didn't invent). → morality is autonomous. This is the classic refutation of strong DCT.



- Secular ethics: utilitarianism, contractarianism, virtue ethics, humanism — all ground morality without theism. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

3. THE INTERACTION VIEW — mutual influence (2023 PYQ) [FACT]**KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC**

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion and morality are conceptually distinguishable yet historically interactive: religion shapes moral formation, while moral criticism reforms religious practice.

- Morality influences/refines religion: moral conscience critiques religious practice (prophets against ritualism; reform movements against caste/sati); a religion is judged by its ethical fruits (James). [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

- Indian view: dharma (moral-religious duty and order) fuses the religious and the moral — right conduct is the cosmic-religious order; karma (action and moral causation) links moral action to spiritual destiny (morality is soteriologically serious). [FACT]

- Religion influences moral behaviour: provides motivation (reward/punishment, love of God), community & sanction, moral exemplars, and a worldview that sustains moral commitment. [FACT]



- Empirically: religion can promote pro-social behaviour and (misused) sanction intolerance/violence — the relation is contingent, not automatic. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

**4. COMPARISON GRID [INFERENCE / CAUTION]**

Divine Command	right = God's command	DCT, Dostoevsky	Euthyphro: arbitrariness
Autonomy	morality = reason	Kant	motivation/why-be-moral gap
Independence (secular)	ethics needs no God	utilitarians, humanists	grounding of obligation
Interaction	mutual reinforcement	James, Indian dharma (moral-religious duty and order)	relation is contingent
Indian (dharma (moral-religious duty and order))	moral = religious order	Gītā, Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)	—

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

[MNEMONIC] Balanced conclusion: the Euthyphro shows morality cannot be wholly reducible to divine command (else arbitrary), so morality has autonomy; yet religion powerfully motivates and sustains morality, and morality purifies religion — hence the interaction view, not strict dependence, is soundest.

5. FOUNDATIONAL STATEMENT BANK [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

1. [FACT] The Euthyphro dilemma asks whether divine approval constitutes goodness or responds to goodness.

3. [FACT] Kant grounds moral obligation in rational autonomy and relates religion to the requirements of practical reason.

5. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Indian dharma (moral-religious duty and order) frequently combines moral, ritual, social and soteriological dimensions; it is not reducible to any one of them.

2. [SOURCE CAUTION] The sentence commonly rendered as "If God does not exist, everything is permitted" is a summary of a Dostoevskian theme, not a safe verbatim quotation.



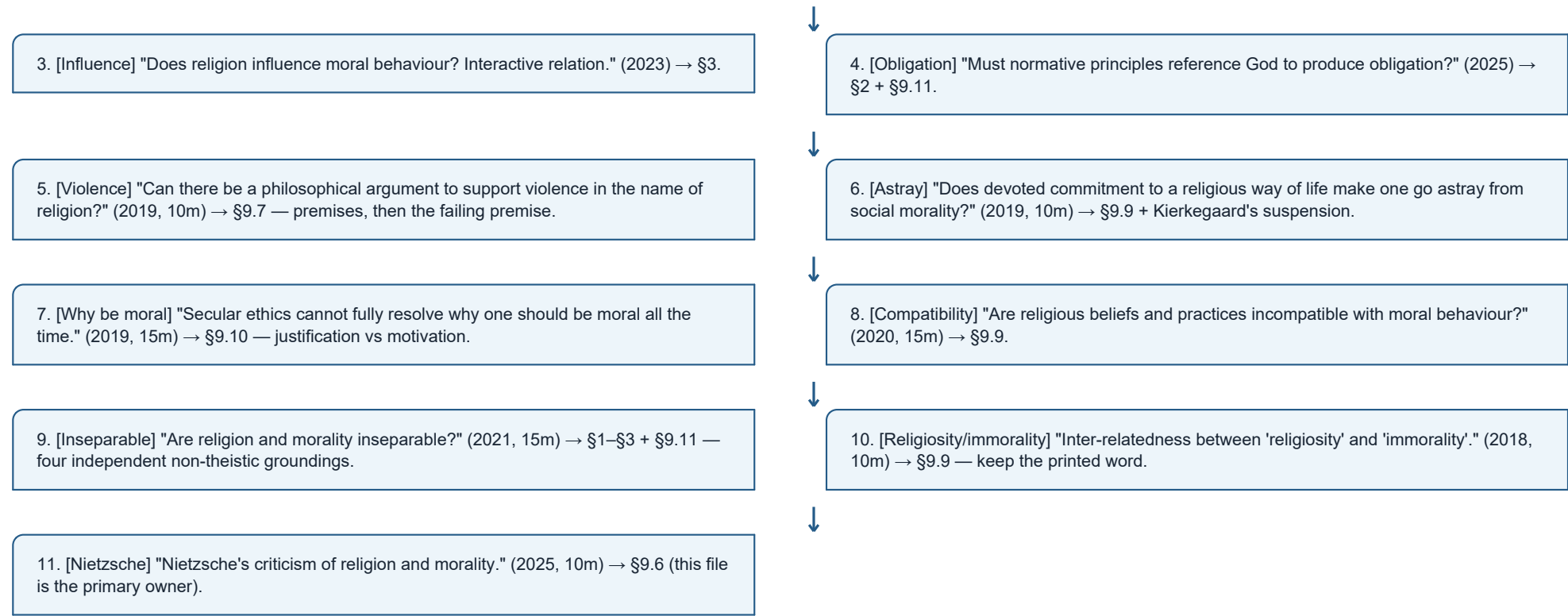
4. [FACT] James's pragmatic test directs attention to the fruits of religious life.



6. APPLIED-QUESTION DRILLS [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

1. [Asymmetry] "'Morality without religion, but not religion without morality.' Discuss." (2022) → §1.

2. [Religion without morality] "Can there be a religion without morality?" (2024) → §1.



6A. PARITY BENCH — grounding morality with and without God [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The key analytical distinction is between what makes an act right, what justifies belief in its rightness and what motivates an agent to perform it.

Strong DCT	God's command	? Impaled on a horn	[FACT] By sanction	Arbitrariness
Modified DCT (Adams)	God's loving nature	[FACT] Blocks arbitrariness	[FACT] By love, not fear	"Loving" presupposes goodness
Natural law	Human goods under divine reason	[FACT] Mediates the horns	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Partly	Nature-to-norm

Kant	Rational self-legislation	[FACT] Not applicable	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Justifies, does not motivate	Formalism
Contractarian	Mutual advantage	[FACT] Not applicable	? The perfect knave survives	Detectability of dispositions
Karma (action and moral causation)/dharma (moral-religious duty and order)	Cosmic moral order	[FACT] No commander needed	[FACT] Exhaustive — no undetected act	Unverifiability
Buddhist (Śāntideva)	Ownerless suffering + anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine)	[FACT] Not applicable	[FACT] Impartiality is rationally required	Depends on anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine)
Jain	Ahiṃsā (non-violence), graded vows	[FACT] Not applicable	[FACT] Vow-structure	Rigorism
Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)	Vedic injunction alone	[FACT] No personal commander	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Ritual-bounded	Authority outside the tradition

7. PYQ-MAPPED MODEL-ANSWER SKELETONS [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

7.1 — "'One can have morality without religion but not religion without morality.' Discuss." (2022, 10m)

Intro : examine the asymmetry between the two directions.
Body : religion WITHOUT morality – impossible (every religion prescribes an ethic; internal link);
 morality WITHOUT religion – possible (Kant's autonomy, secular ethics, humanism).
Assess: Euthyphro blocks strong DCT; yet religion motivates/sustains morality (interaction).
Concl : the asymmetry holds – morality is autonomous, religion is ethically constituted.

7.2 — "Must normative principles reference God to produce obligation?" (2025, 15m)

Intro : the Divine Command claim vs the autonomy claim.
Body : DCT – obligation from God's will (Dostoevsky); BUT Euthyphro → arbitrariness;
 Kant – obligation from rational autonomy (categorical imperative), no God needed;
 secular ethics grounds duty without theism.
Assess: God can MOTIVATE obligation but is not its logical GROUND; morality is autonomous.
Concl : normative principles need not reference God to obligate, though religion can reinforce them.

7.3 — "Can there be a philosophical argument to support violence in the name of religion?" (2019, 10m)

Intro : the question is about the STRUCTURE OF JUSTIFICATION, not the history of conflict.
 Assess arguments; name no community.

Body : state each candidate in premises, then locate the failing premise –

- (1) divine command → fails at P2: no fallible agent can infallibly identify the divine will (Kierkegaard concedes Abraham cannot make himself intelligible → no public justification);
- (2) defence of the sacred → fails at P2: it confuses supreme VALUE with vulnerability;
- (3) coerce-for-salvation → fails at P2 empirically: Locke – force compels profession, not belief; coerced religion yields hypocrisy (Augustine's compelle intrare as the historical counter-position, examined not endorsed);
- (4) cosmic dualism → fails at P2: total demonisation contradicts image-of-God / ahimsā (non-violence) / ātman-in-all anthropologies;
- (5) identity-honour → not a religious argument at all.

General rebuttals: Euthyphro; epistemic fallibility; Gandhi's means-end unity; internal critiques.

Concl : no SOUND argument survives; only the ordinary defensive-force permission, which is not religious. Religion's distinctive contribution here is restraint, not licence.

7.4 — "Secular ethics cannot fully resolve why one should be moral all the time." (2019, 15m)

Intro : the weight is on "all the time" – the undetected, costly, unreciprocated act.

Setup : Ring of Gyges; Hobbes' Foole; Hume's sensible knave; Bradley/Prichard on whether the question is even well-formed.

Secular answers and their limits:

- Kant (categorical, not conditional – but justifies rather than motivates);
- Gauthier's constrained maximisation (works only where dispositions are detectable);
- Aristotelian eudaimonism (presupposes a thick nature the sceptic can decline);
- sympathy/reciprocity (explains a motive; has an exception clause for the undetected case).

Religious answers: divine sanction (works, but heteronomous – Kantian cost);

- divine love (escapes heteronomy);
- KARMA (action and moral causation) – exhaustive and impersonal: no unobserved act, no bribable judge, so Gyges' ring is irrelevant; niškāma-karma (action without attachment to results) (Gītā 2.47, 3.19) DISSOLVES the question by removing the fruit from deliberation; dharma (moral-religious duty and order)/ṛta (cosmic order) makes morality the grain of reality, not a constraint on it.

Assess: separate JUSTIFICATION from MOTIVATION. Secular ethics answers the first; the printed claim bites only on the second – and religion's advantage there is scope, purchased at the price of heteronomy if it works through sanction.

Concl : half true – and the half that is true is motivational, not logical.

7.5 — "Present an account of Nietzsche's criticism of religion and morality." (2025, 10m)

Intro : the two halves are inseparable – the death of God and the genealogy of the morality it bore.
Body : (1) "God is dead" (Gay Science §125) as CULTURAL DIAGNOSIS, not atheological argument;
(2) Genealogy I – good/bad (noble) inverted into good/evil by the slave revolt; resentment as creative and REACTIVE;
(3) Genealogy II – guilt from debt; bad conscience as instinct turned inward;
(4) Genealogy III – the ascetic ideal gave suffering a meaning ("rather will nothingness than not will"); modern science is its latest form and destroys the belief in God;
(5) Christianity as "Platonism for the people" (BGE Preface); pity as life-denying;
(6) positive – revaluation, will to power, Übermensch, eternal recurrence, amor fati; nihilism is the interim, not the goal.
Crit : genetic fallacy (origin ≠ validity); no criterion for a better creation of values; Scheler's Ressentiment – Christian love descends from abundance, not impotence; appropriation risk.
Indian: the Gītā's charge of klāibya (2.3) resembles the diagnosis but prescribes svadharma (one's own role-specific duty), not self-created value; Nietzsche's "life-denying" charge against Buddhism misreads nirvāṇa (liberation from suffering) as cessation of life rather than of craving, and ignores karuṇā (compassion) and the middle way.
Concl : the critique of morality outlives the programme that was to replace it.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH

NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

The advanced dossier confirms that modified divine-command theory is now core. Its optional residue is whether grounding goodness in a necessarily loving divine nature relocates rather than solves Euthyphro. Natural law provides a middle route between command and autonomy. Evolutionary debunking and role-dharma versus universal critique remain bounded advanced extensions.

9. ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS

9.1 Divine command theory

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (Recommended opening definition): Divine command theory identifies moral obligation with God's command, thereby securing authority but facing the Euthyphro dilemma between arbitrariness and independent goodness.

- Doctrine statement. [FACT] Moral obligation consists in being commanded by God; modified versions ground commands in an essentially loving divine nature.



- Argument. [FACT] (1) Obligation has authority over preference; (2) a supreme personal legislator can issue universally binding commands; (3) divine knowledge and goodness secure right content; (4) accountability supplies motivational seriousness.

- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] God exists, divine commands are knowable, and authority can generate moral reasons.

- Distinction. [FACT] Semantic dependence ("wrong" means forbidden) differs from metaphysical dependence (wrongness is constituted by prohibition) and motivational dependence (belief in God motivates compliance).

- Canonical example. [FACT] Abrahamic command cases test whether obedience can override ordinary moral judgement.

- Objection → reply. [FACT] Euthyphro: arbitrary command or independent goodness. Modified theory replies that commands express God's necessarily loving nature, though critics ask whether love is good independently.

9.2 Kantian autonomy

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Kant, an act has moral worth when performed from a rationally self-legislated duty, not from fear of divine punishment or hope of reward.

- Doctrine statement. [FACT] Moral obligation arises from rational self-legislation under universally valid law, not heteronomous reward, punishment or command.

- Argument. [FACT] (1) Moral worth requires action from duty; (2) contingent desire cannot yield necessity; (3) rational agents test maxims for universal law; (4) autonomy is obedience to reason one shares as rational.

- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Practical reason can generate categorical norms.

- Distinction. [FACT] Autonomy is not doing whatever one wants; it is freedom under self-given universal rational law.

- Canonical example. [FACT] A truthful act motivated only by fear of divine punishment lacks the same autonomous moral worth as action from duty.

- Objection → reply. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Formal universalisation may underdetermine content. Kantian replies add humanity as an end and a kingdom of ends.

9.3 Natural law and theistic moral realism

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Natural-law ethics avoids crude voluntarism by grounding moral norms in the rational order of created nature, though it must still explain disputed accounts of human flourishing.

- Doctrine statement. [FACT] Moral norms are rationally accessible participations in an objective order grounded ultimately in divine reason, not arbitrary decrees.



- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Human nature has intelligible normative ends.



- Canonical example. [FACT] Preservation of life and social cooperation are treated as basic goods, not good merely because a text commands them.



- Argument. [FACT] Human goods and inclinations disclose basic ends; practical reason directs conduct toward them; divine grounding explains their objective order.

- Distinction. [FACT] Natural law mediates between command theory and secular autonomy: God grounds order, but reason knows much of it without revelation.

- Objection → reply. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The move from nature to norm risks the naturalistic fallacy. Reply: practical reason grasps goods as reasons, not as bare biological facts.

9.4 Indian dharma (moral-religious duty and order), karma (action and moral causation) and critique

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dharma (moral-religious duty and order) and karma (action and moral causation) connect conduct with cosmic order, but the Bhagavad Gītā's niṣkāma-karma (action without attachment to results) shifts moral worth from reward to duty.

- Doctrine statement. [FACT] Dharma (moral-religious duty and order) joins normative order, social role, ritual duty and soteriological consequence; karma (action and moral causation) connects conduct to future experience without requiring command in every school.



- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Moral action participates in a wider causal or liberative order.

- Argument. [FACT] Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school) grounds duty in Vedic injunction; the Gītā reworks duty through detached action and devotion; Buddhism grounds ethics in intention, suffering and the path; Jainism radicalises non-violence.

- Distinction. [FACT] Dharma (moral-religious duty and order) is not simply morality: it can include ritual and role-specific duty, which makes internal moral criticism necessary.

- Objection → reply. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Role-dharma can preserve hierarchy. Reformist reply appeals to deeper norms—non-harm, equality, conscience and spiritual unity—to criticise inherited practice.

- Canonical examples. [FACT] Arjuna's conflict between warrior duty and aversion to killing; Buddhist intention (cetanā); Jain ahimsā (non-violence).

9.5 Religion's moral influence

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion can intensify moral motivation through identity, exemplars, community and accountability, but religiosity is neither necessary nor sufficient for moral conduct.

- Argument. [FACT] Narrative exemplars, ritual formation, community sanctions, hope and repentance can stabilise conduct; prophetic criticism can challenge institutions.

- Distinction. [FACT] Causal influence does not establish logical dependence or moral truth.

- Objection → reply. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Religious conflict shows corrupting influence. Reply: distinguish religion's ethical resources from identity mobilisation and interpretive abuse; this is explanatory, not exculpatory.

- Doctrine statement. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Religion can motivate, socialise and symbolically deepen morality, but influence is contingent and may also legitimise exclusion.

- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Belief and practice meaningfully shape agency but do not mechanically determine it.

- Canonical example. [FACT] A vow of non-violence may be strengthened by religious discipline, while its moral defensibility still requires reasons accessible beyond the community.

9.6 Nietzsche's criticism of religion and morality (2025 Q5(c) — primary owner)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche's genealogy criticises Christian morality as a reversal born of resentment, yet his revaluation risks elitism unless value-creation can be normatively constrained. [FACT] Ownership note. The 2025 stem couples religion with morality, so this file is the primary owner and carries the full dossier. Religion without God §3/§9.4 retains Nietzsche only as a critique of theism and as the bridge to post-theistic value, and routes the PYQ here.

- Doctrine statement. [FACT] Nietzsche's critique has two inseparable halves: a diagnosis of the collapse of the theistic-metaphysical worldview ("God is dead"), and a genealogy of the morality that worldview underwrote, which he judges to be life-denying.



- (a) "God is dead." [FACT] The Gay Science §125 — the madman announces that we have killed God and asks who will wipe the blood off us. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Read it correctly: it is a cultural diagnosis, not an atheological argument. The claim is that the Christian-metaphysical framework has become unbelievable to the very culture built on it, and that the culture has not yet grasped the consequences. §108 and §343 make the delayed-consequences point explicitly.

- (b) The genealogy of morals. [FACT] On the Genealogy of Morality (1887):



- First essay — "Good and Evil", "Good and Bad". The original aristocratic valuation is good/bad: "good" names the noble, strong, affirming type, and "bad" is merely the contrasting low. The slave revolt in morality begins when resentment — the impotent resentment of those who cannot act — becomes creative and produces values. It inverts the scheme: the noble is renamed evil, and the powerless, meek and abstinent become good. The decisive point is that slave morality is reactive: it says No to an outside first, and derives its Yes from that No.

- Second essay — guilt, bad conscience. Nietzsche derives moral guilt (Schuld) from the economic relation of debt (Schulden); when outward discharge of instinct is blocked by society, cruelty turns inward and produces the "bad conscience"; religion then maximises this by positing an infinite creditor who cannot be repaid.



- Third essay — the ascetic ideal. The ascetic ideal gave suffering a meaning, which is why it prevailed: "man would rather will nothingness than not will". Its final irony is that modern science and the will to truth are themselves the ascetic ideal's latest form — and it is that unconditional will to truth which finally destroys the belief in God.

- (c) The critique of Christianity specifically. [FACT] Beyond Good and Evil, Preface: Christianity is "Platonism for the people" — the transfer of a two-world metaphysics to the masses. In The Antichrist he attacks pity (Mitleid) as a multiplier of suffering and a preserver of the ill-constituted, and treats the church as an inversion of the values that make life ascend. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Use paraphrase; his rhetoric is extreme and misquotation is easy.



- (d) The positive programme. [FACT] Revaluation of all values; the will to power as the interpretive principle of valuation; the Übermensch of Thus Spoke Zarathustra as the type who creates values rather than receiving them; eternal recurrence as the ultimate test of affirmation; amor fati. Nihilism is the interim condition between the collapse of the old values and the creation of new ones — Nietzsche is its diagnostician and its opponent, not its advocate.

- Objections → replies. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

2. Missing criterion. If all values are created, on what basis is the Übermensch's creation better? Reply: the standard is internal — self-overcoming, affirmation, the capacity to will one's life eternally — but critics reply that this is a preference, not a norm.

4. Political appropriation. The doctrine is vulnerable to elitist and worse readings — a vulnerability that is partly a feature of Nietzsche's own rhetoric, even though his sister's editorial role in the posthumous material is well documented [SOURCE CAUTION].

- The Gītā's opening is structurally the same accusation: Kṛṣṇa charges Arjuna with klaibya — unmanliness/impotence (2.3) — and calls him to act. But the resemblance stops there: the Gītā's remedy is svadharma (one's own role-specific duty) and non-attachment, a duty-ethic grounded in cosmic order, not a self-legislated creation of values.

- Presupposition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] That valuations have histories traceable to types of life, and that they can be assessed as life-enhancing or life-denying — which presupposes a normative standard ("life", "ascending life") that Nietzsche never systematically justifies.

1. Genetic fallacy. Showing that a value originated in resentment does not show it is false or unjustified. Reply: Nietzsche's target is not truth-value but value: he asks what kind of life a valuation expresses and produces — a distinct, non-fallacious question, though it does not deliver the refutation his rhetoric suggests.

3. Caricature of Christian ethics. Agapeic love, prophetic justice and the dignity of the person are not reducible to resentment. [FACT] Max Scheler (Ressentiment, 1912) argues directly that Christian love descends from abundance, not from impotence — the single best-named counter-authority to cite.

- Indian comparison (mandatory for parity, and genuinely illuminating). [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

- Nietzsche's charge that Buddhism is "life-denying" [FACT] is a real and repeated claim of his — and is standardly answered: nirvāṇa (liberation from suffering) is the cessation of craving, not of life; karuṇā (compassion) is an active, other-regarding energy; and the Buddha's middle way explicitly rejects self-mortification, which is precisely the ascetic ideal Nietzsche attacks. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Nietzsche in fact rates Buddhism above Christianity as "more realistic" while still classing it as nihilistic — say this precisely rather than flattening it.

- Cārvāka (materialist school) is the closest Indian analogue in conclusion (this-worldly value, rejection of the priestly order) but not in method: it is empiricist where Nietzsche is genealogical.

- Verdict formula. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "Nietzsche's achievement is to make morality itself an object of historical and psychological suspicion, and to show that the death of God is a problem for ethics before it is a problem for theology. His failure is the constructive half: the revaluation supplies no criterion by which one creation of values is better than another, which is why his critique is more durable than his solution."

9.7 Religious violence: is there a philosophical argument for it? (2019 Q5(c) owner-module)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No act becomes justified merely by being religiously authorised; a defensible argument must independently satisfy legitimate authority, just cause, proportionality, necessity and discrimination. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Handling rule. Treat this as a philosophical question about the structure of justification, not as a survey of atrocities, and not as a comment on any living community. Assess arguments; name no contemporary group.

- The candidate arguments, stated fairly, then tested. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

2. Defence-of-the-sacred argument. P1: The sacred is of supreme value. P2: Supreme value may be defended by force. C: Violence in defence of the sacred is permitted. — Test: P2 conflates value with vulnerability. Persons can be defended by force because they can be harmed; the sacred, on most theologies, cannot be diminished by an insult, so the premise misdescribes what is at stake.

- The exact question. [FACT] Not "have religions been violent?" (a historical question) but "can a philosophical argument support violence in the name of religion?" — i.e., is there a valid argument with religious premises whose conclusion licenses violence?

1. Divine-command argument. P1: Whatever God commands is obligatory. P2: God has commanded this act. C: The act is obligatory, whatever its ordinary moral appearance. — Test: the argument is formally valid; it fails on P2, which requires an infallible identification of the divine will that no fallible agent possesses. Kierkegaard's "teleological suspension of the ethical" concedes exactly this: Abraham cannot make himself intelligible, and therefore cannot make a public case. An argument that cannot be publicly assessed cannot function as a justification to others.

CONTINUATION 1/2

3. Soteriological paternalism ("coerce for their own good"). P1: Eternal salvation outweighs temporal harm. P2: Coercion can produce conformity that leads to salvation. C: Coercion is a benefit. — Test: P2 is false, and this is the decisive philosophical refutation. Locke's A Letter Concerning Toleration (1689): the magistrate's force can compel outward profession but "the understanding cannot be compelled to the belief of anything by outward force"; belief is not directly voluntary, so coerced religion produces hypocrisy, not salvation. [FACT] Augustine's use of compelle intrare (Luke 14:23) in the Donatist controversy is the standard historical counter-instance, and it

CONTINUATION 2/2

is a historical position to be examined, not an endorsement.

5. Identity/honour argument. — Test: this is not a religious argument at all but a group-identity argument wearing religious vocabulary; it is refuted by the ordinary objections to collective punishment.

CONTINUATION 2/2

sacrifice, the doctrine of the dignity of the person.

- Verdict formula. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "There is no sound philosophical argument for violence in the name of religion. The valid-looking arguments fail at a premise — the identification of the divine will, the vulnerability of the sacred, the efficacy of coercion, or the total evil of the adversary. What survives is the general moral permission of defensive force, which is not religious at all; religion's distinctive contribution to this question is the imposition of limits, not the grant of a licence."

4. Cosmic-dualist/apocalyptic argument. P1: History is a war between absolute good and absolute evil. P2: Opponents instantiate absolute evil. C: Restraint toward them is complicity. — Test: P2 is the flaw — the total demonisation of persons is precisely what most religious anthropologies (image of God; the Buddha-nature; ātman (self) in all beings; ahimsā (non-violence)) deny.

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- The general rebuttals. [FACT] (a) Euthyphro: if the act is wrong, calling it commanded does not make it right; if it is right, the command is not what makes it so. (b) Epistemic fallibility: revelation-claims are contested even inside a tradition, so no agent is entitled to the certainty the argument requires. (c) Means–end unity: Gandhi's insistence that means and ends are inseparable — "the means may be likened to a seed, the end to a tree" — denies that a sacred end can sanctify an unholy means. (d) The internal-critique point: every major tradition contains its own resources against violence — ahimsā (non-violence), the Buddhist first precept, the prophetic critique of

- What survives. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Only the ordinary, non-religious justification of defensive force — self-defence and the protection of the innocent — survives, and it is available to a secular ethic as well. Religion adds no independent licence. What religion can legitimately add is a restraint: many traditions impose limits on defensive force stricter than secular law requires.

9.8 Just war, jihād (striving in the path of God) and dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits): comparing normative frameworks

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Just-war reasoning, jihād (striving in the path of God) and dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits) are comparable as attempts to subject force to moral limits, not as permissions for unlimited sacred violence. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Handling rule (non-negotiable). These are internally contested normative traditions with long juristic histories. Compare their criteria; do not adjudicate between faiths, do not characterise any community, and mark contested points with [SOURCE CAUTION]. The examinable content is the structure of restraint, which is where the three converge.

- Jus ad bellum — just cause, competent authority, right intention, proportionality of ends, last resort, reasonable prospect of success, and the aim of a just peace.

CONTINUATION 1/3

- Islamic juristic tradition. [FACT] Jihād (striving in the path of God) means striving/exertion; the classical juristic literature treats armed struggle under the distinct term qitāl (armed fighting) (fighting), which is hedged by conditions: proper authority, just cause, and restraints that the jurists derive from prophetic practice — non-combatants (women, children, the aged, the clergy) are not to be targeted, crops and trees are not to be wantonly destroyed, treaties are to be honoured, and mutilation is forbidden. [SOURCE CAUTION] The widely cited distinction between the "greater jihād (striving in the path of God)"

CONTINUATION 3/3

tradition by mainstream jurists; a philosophy answer should note the internal contestation rather than treating any one reading as "the" doctrine.

- Just war (Western, Christian-derived, now largely secular). [FACT] Augustine and Aquinas supply the classical core; Aquinas' three conditions (ST II-II q.40) are legitimate authority (auctoritas principis), just cause (causa iusta) and right intention (intentio recta). The later tradition, systematised in modern form by Michael Walzer (Just and Unjust Wars, 1977), separates:

- Jus in bello — discrimination (non-combatant immunity) and proportionality of means; later writers add jus post bellum.

CONTINUATION 2/3

(the inner struggle against the self, jihād al-naḥs (struggle against the lower self)) and the "lesser jihād (striving in the path of God)" (outward fighting) rests on a report whose authenticity is disputed by ḥadīth scholars — cite it, but flag the dispute rather than asserting it as canonical. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The territorial categories dār al-islām (abode of Islam)/dār al-ḥarb (abode of war) are juristic constructions of a particular historical period, not Qur'ānic terms, and their contemporary applicability is contested within the tradition. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Modern militant reinterpretations that dispense with authority-conditions and non-combatant immunity are contested from within the

CONTINUATION 1/2

- Dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits) (Indian). [FACT] The Mahābhārata (especially the Śānti- and Anuśāsana-parvans) and the Dharmaśāstra literature set out rules of righteous war: war only after the graded political means (sāma, dāna, bheda, daṇḍa (punishment and state coercion)) are exhausted; do not strike one who is asleep, unarmed, fleeing, surrendering, wounded, disarmed, a non-combatant, or engaged with another; fight only an equal; hostilities cease at sunset; poisoned and barbed weapons are forbidden; envoys, physicians, farmers and their property are protected. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The internal tension is the examinable point: the epic itself narrates repeated

CONTINUATION 2/2

violations, and Kauṭilya's Arthaśāstra explicitly countenances kūṭa-yuddha (deceptive or irregular warfare) (concealed/stratagem warfare) on grounds of state-interest, against the epic's dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits) ideal. The Indian tradition therefore contains its own realist counter-tradition, and a good answer names it. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The Gītā's justification of Arjuna's fighting is a svadharma (one's own role-specific duty) argument internal to a specific narrative situation; Gandhi's allegorical reading (the battlefield as the human heart) is one influential interpretation among several, not the plain sense.



- Convergence and divergence.

Legitimate authority	[FACT] Required (Aquinas)	[FACT] Required	[FACT] Required (the rājan)
Just cause	[FACT] Required	[FACT] Required	[FACT] Required
Right intention	[FACT] Explicit	[FACT] Emphasised (intention/niyya)	[FACT] Detachment from hatred (Gītā's niṣkāma framing)
Last resort	[FACT]	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Present in juristic conditions	[FACT] Sāma-dāna-bheda before daṇḍa (punishment and state coercion)
Non-combatant immunity	[FACT] Central	[FACT] Explicit prohibitions	[FACT] Detailed lists of the protected
Proportionality of means	[FACT]	[FACT]	[FACT] (prohibited weapons)
Temporal/spatial limits	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Not classical	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Truce and treaty rules	[FACT] Cease at sunset; fight only equals
Internal realist counter-tradition	[FACT] Realism, raison d'état	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Contested modern readings	[FACT] Kauṭilya's kūṭa-yuddha (deceptive or irregular warfare)

- The philosophical yield. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Three independent traditions converge on authority, cause, intention, discrimination and proportionality. That convergence is evidence that the constraints are rationally derivable rather than revelation-dependent — which cuts against the claim that religion supplies a special licence and for the claim that religion supplies culturally embedded restraint. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Every one of the three also contains an internal counter-tradition that relaxes the constraints under necessity, which is the honest qualification.

- Verdict formula. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "The three frameworks are best compared as competing restraint-regimes, not as licences. Their convergence on authority, cause, intention, discrimination and proportionality suggests these are conclusions of practical reason that each tradition articulates in its own idiom; their internal realist counter-currents show that no tradition has fully solved the problem of necessity."

9.9 Religiosity and "immorality" (2018 Q5(d) owner-module)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious profession and moral conduct are empirically separable because belief may motivate action, rationalise misconduct or remain behaviourally inert. [SOURCE CAUTION] The held 2018 paper visibly prints "immorality". The module treats that printed term; do not silently regularise it to "morality".

- Arguments for a positive connection (i.e. that religiosity can generate immorality).
[INFERENCE / CAUTION]

2. The in-group/out-group argument. Religiosity binds a community by marking a boundary, and boundary-marking has a predictable moral cost toward outsiders. [FACT] Gordon Allport's distinction between intrinsic religiosity (religion as an end in itself) and extrinsic religiosity (religion as an instrument for status, security or belonging) — with Daniel Batson's later addition of the quest orientation — is the standard analytical apparatus: the moral correlations differ sharply by orientation, which is why "religiosity" as such correlates with nothing simple.

4. The scrupulosity/licensing arguments. Religiosity can produce pathological guilt on one side and moral licensing ("I have observed, therefore I am good") on the other.

- Reading the stem. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "Is there an inter-relatedness between religiosity and immorality?" asks whether being religious (a psychological and behavioural disposition) is systematically connected with moral failure. It is not the same as "is religion moral?" — the subject is religiosity, the disposition, not religion, the system.

1. The ritual-substitution argument. Religiosity can displace moral substance with observance. This is the standing prophetic critique inside the traditions: the Hebrew prophets denounce festivals and sacrifices offered without justice (Amos 5, Isaiah 1); the Buddha criticises Vedic sacrifice as ineffective; Kabir and Nānak attack ritualism and caste-observance; the Gītā (2.42–43) disparages those enchanted by "flowery words" of ritual reward. [FACT] That every tradition contains this critique is itself the evidence that the danger is real.

3. The suspension argument. If religious duty can override ordinary ethics, religiosity supplies a route to acts that are, judged ethically, immoral — Kierkegaard's teleological suspension of the ethical is the honest philosophical statement of this.

- Arguments against a systematic connection. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] (1) Every tradition also generates reformers, ascetics and moral exemplars, so the correlation is not with religiosity but with its orientation. (2) The immoral religionist is judged by the tradition's own norms — the phenomenon is internal corruption, not a counter-example to religious ethics. (3) The comparison class matters: secular ideologies have generated comparable moral failures, so "religiosity" is not the differentiating variable.

- The precise verdict. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Religiosity is morally ambivalent, not morally aligned: it amplifies whatever moral content the religion supplies and whatever motive the individual brings. Its ethical value is therefore a function of two things: (i) whether the religion's ultimate is itself moralised (a God whose nature is goodness, a dharma (moral-religious duty and order) that is justice), and (ii) whether the individual's orientation is intrinsic or extrinsic.

- Verdict formula. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "There is a genuine inter-relatedness, but it is conditional, not necessary. Religiosity does not produce immorality; it magnifies the moral content it is attached to, and the traditions' own prophetic critiques show that they know it."

- Objection → reply. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Objection: this makes religiosity morally inert. Reply: not inert — an amplifier is not neutral in effect, only in direction; and traditions can be assessed by how strongly they build internal critique and moral universalism into the amplification.



9.10 "Why be moral — all the time?" (2019 Q7(b) owner-module)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The demand to be moral 'all the time' tests integrity under secrecy: religion may reinforce compliance, but moral justification cannot be reduced to surveillance or reward.

- The exact stem. [FACT] "Secular ethics cannot fully resolve as to why one should be moral all the time." The load is carried by "all the time" — the hard case is morality when it is costly, undetected and unenforced.



CONTINUATION 1/2

- The classical statements of the problem. [FACT] Glaucon's Ring of Gyges (Republic II): given invisibility, would anyone remain just? — the challenge is to show justice is good in itself, not for its reputation. [FACT] Hobbes' Foole: the one who says in his heart there is no justice, and that covenant-breaking is rational when it pays. [FACT] Hume's sensible knave (Enquiry Concerning the Principles of Morals, IX.ii): the person who observes the rules generally but makes exceptions when they profit and go undetected — Hume admits he finds the knave hard to answer, and falls back on the "inward peace of mind" and integrity that the knave forfeits. [FACT] F. H. Bradley

CONTINUATION 2/2

(Ethical Studies, Essay II, "Why Should I Be Moral?"): the question may be self-defeating, because to ask for a non-moral reason to be moral is to ask morality to justify itself before a tribunal it does not recognise; [FACT] H. A. Prichard, "Does Moral Philosophy Rest on a Mistake?" (1912), makes the parallel point that demanding a self-interested justification of obligation misconstrues obligation.



- The secular answers, and where each stops. [INFERENCE / CAUTION]

- Kantian: the question is confused — a categorical imperative is by definition not conditional on desire, and the rational agent legislating universally is not asking "what's in it for me?" Limit: it explains why the moral law binds, not why this agent will act on it when inclination pulls hard.



- Contractarian (Hobbes, Gauthier): morality is the rational output of mutually advantageous constraint; Gauthier's constrained maximisation argues that being disposed to keep agreements is itself the utility-maximising disposition. Limit: the disposition-argument works where dispositions are detectable; the perfect knave with a perfect mask remains unanswered.

- Sentimentalist/evolutionary: sympathy, reciprocity and reputation explain both the origin and the motive. Limit: explaining a motive is not justifying a norm — and reciprocity has an explicit exception clause for the undetected case.

CONTINUATION 2/2

Ring of Gyges has no purchase where invisibility to persons is irrelevant. (4) [FACT] Niṣkāma-karma (action without attachment to results) (Gītā 2.47, 3.19): the deepest Indian move is to dissolve the question — one acts because the act is svadharma (one's own role-specific duty), having renounced the fruit, so "what do I get?" has already been removed from the deliberation. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] (5) Dharma (moral-religious duty and order)/ṛta as cosmic order: morality is not a constraint imposed on nature but the grain of it, so immorality is a form of disorder, not merely a rule-violation.

CONTINUATION 2/2

and heteronomy objections identify.

- Eudaimonist/virtue-ethical (Aristotle): being moral is partly constitutive of flourishing, so the question "why be moral?" mistakes a component of the good life for a cost. Limit: it presupposes a thick account of human nature that the sceptic can decline.

CONTINUATION 1/2

- The religious answers — and what they actually add. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] (1) Divine sanction: the undetected case does not exist, because God sees. Limit: prudential motivation is heteronomous and, by Kant's lights, morally worthless — a serious cost. (2) Divine love/relationship: mature theism motivates by love of the good and of God, not fear — this escapes the heteronomy objection. (3) [FACT] Karma (action and moral causation): the strongest Indian answer to the "all the time" clause. Karma (action and moral causation) is exhaustive and impersonal: there is no unobserved act, no bribable judge, no escape by concealment, and no gap between the moral order and the causal order. The

CONTINUATION 1/2

- Assessment. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The distinction that must be drawn is between justification and motivation. Secular ethics can justify moral norms (Kant, contractarianism, virtue ethics all supply grounds). Where the printed claim has force is on motivation in the hard case: the undetected, costly, unreciprocated act. Religion's distinctive contribution there is scope — a moral order coextensive with reality, from which nothing is exempt — and that is a motivational, not a logical, advantage. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The counter-cost is equally real: a motivation grounded in sanction is morally inferior to one grounded in the good itself, so the religious advantage is purchased at the price the Euthyphro

- Verdict formula. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "The claim is half true. Secular ethics resolves the justificatory question as well as any theory can; it is weaker on the motivational question in the undetected, costly case. Religion's answer there — karma (action and moral causation)'s exhaustiveness, or love of the good — has genuine reach, but if it operates through sanction it wins the motivation and loses the moral worth."

9.11 Divine command refined, and the non-theistic grounding of ethics

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A refined theistic ethic may present God as the perfectly good recogniser and motivator of moral value rather than the arbitrary creator of goodness.

CONTINUATION 2/2

arbitrariness.

- [FACT] Divine motivation theory (Linda Zagzebski) is the virtue-theoretic variant: God's motives, not God's commands, are the metaphysical ground of moral value.

CONTINUATION 1/2

1. Buddhist. Ethics is grounded in intention (cetanā), the causal structure of dukkha (suffering and unsatisfactoriness), and the cultivation of the brahmavihāras (four sublime meditative abodes) (mettā, karuṇā (compassion), muditā, upekkhā). [FACT] Śāntideva's argument in the Bodhicaryāvatāra (Guide to the Bodhisattva's Way of Life) (VIII) is the strongest philosophical piece: since there is no substantial self, suffering is ownerless; the reason to relieve my future suffering is exactly as strong as the reason to relieve another's, since the boundary between them is a conventional construction. This grounds impartial altruism on a metaphysical rather than a

2. Jain. Ahimsā (non-violence) as the supreme vow, extended to all jīva (living soul)s in proportion to their sense-capacity; the aṇuvrata (limited Jain vow)/mahāvratā (great Jain vow) structure grades obligation by vocation; and anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) functions as an ethic of intellectual non-violence — refusing to do epistemic harm by absolutising one's own standpoint.

CONTINUATION 1/2

- Modified divine command theory. [FACT] Robert Merrihew Adams (Finite and Infinite Goods, 1999) reformulates DCT so that moral obligation consists in the commands of a loving God, while goodness is grounded in resemblance to God's own nature rather than in commands. The Euthyphro's first horn is thereby blocked: God cannot command cruelty, because commands issue from an essentially loving nature. [FACT] William Alston's "standard" reply runs parallel: God is the supreme standard of goodness, not a conformer to an external one — as the standard metre bar was the standard of length without there being a further length it had to match, so there is no vicious regress and no

- [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The residual objection (state it — it is what distinguishes an evaluative answer): calling the divine nature "loving" or "good" uses a moral concept whose content we must already grasp independently, otherwise the claim is empty. The modified theory therefore secures non-arbitrariness at the cost of conceding conceptual independence to goodness.

- Non-theistic groundings — the four that matter for parity. [FACT]

CONTINUATION 2/2

theological premise — the single best Indian answer to "can ethics be grounded without God?".

3. Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school). Duty from injunction alone (codanā (Vedic injunction)), with no God and no consequentialist reduction — a pure deontology of the śāstra (authoritative treatise), and a genuine counter-example to the claim that duty needs a commander who is a person.

4. Secular Western. Kantian autonomy, utilitarian welfare, contractarian agreement, and virtue-eudaimonism — all grounding obligation without theistic premises, each with its own well-known difficulty (formalism, demandingness, circularity, thick-nature dependence).



- The comparative verdict. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] The existence of four independently developed non-theistic groundings, two of them Indian and ancient, refutes the strong dependence thesis empirically as well as conceptually. What theistic ethics distinctively supplies is not the content of morality but a claimed unification of obligation, motivation and cosmic significance in a single source — and the price of that unification is the Euthyphro dilemma.

10. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Compare theories by separating moral ontology, epistemic justification, motivation and institutional influence; otherwise distinct claims collapse into the vague assertion that religion and morality are 'related'.

Divine command	[FACT] God's command/nature	Divine authority	Accountability/love	Euthyphro and access
Natural law	[FACT] Objective human goods	Practical reason under divine order	Flourishing	Nature-to-norm
Kant	[FACT] Rational universal law	Autonomy	Respect for law	Formalism
Utilitarianism	[FACT] Consequences/welfare	Impartial maximisation	Sympathy/reason	Rights and demandingness
Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)	[FACT] Vedic injunction/dharma (moral-religious duty and order)	Scriptural authority	Ritual duty/result	Authority outside tradition
Buddhism/Jainism	[FACT] Non-harm, intention, liberation	Insight/vow/path	Compassion and karmic seriousness	Metaphysical warrant
Modified DCT (Adams)	[FACT] Resemblance to God's loving nature	Commands of a loving God	Love, relationship	"Loving" presupposes an independent moral concept
Śāntideva	[FACT] Ownerless suffering (no substantial self)	Impartial reason	Compassion (karuṇā (compassion))	Depends on anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) being true
Nietzsche	? Denies the ground; values are created	Self-legislation of the strong type	Affirmation, self-overcoming	No criterion for better creations

11. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Euthyphro dilemma defeats arbitrary command, not every religious ethic; the strongest reply grounds commands in a necessarily good divine nature.

2. Motivation gap. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Secular reason may identify duty but fail to motivate. Reply: moral motivation can arise from empathy, identity and respect; religion is one source, not logically necessary.

4. Immoral religion. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] A religion may preserve rituals while sanctioning injustice. Reply: if morality is partly constitutive of worthy religion, such practice is internal corruption rather than counterexample to ethical religion.

1. Euthyphro. [FACT] Arbitrary command or independent good. Reply: necessary divine goodness; rejoinder: the normativity of goodness still needs explanation.

3. Heteronomy. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Reward/punishment corrupts moral worth. Reply: mature theism motivates through love of the good, not prudential fear.

**12. COMMON UPSC TRAPS**

1. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not use the sentence commonly paraphrased as "without God everything is permitted" as a verified direct quotation from Dostoevsky.

3. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not equate autonomy with moral subjectivism.

5. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not identify dharma (moral-religious duty and order) wholly with universal morality.

7. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not answer the religious-violence question with a list of conflicts. The stem asks whether a philosophical argument can support it — so state candidate arguments in premises and show which premise fails.

2. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not reduce Euthyphro to "God versus morality"; specify both horns.

4. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not infer logical dependence from sociological influence.

6. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] In "religion without morality," distinguish descriptive institutions from normatively adequate religion.

8. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not characterise any living community, and do not adjudicate between faiths, when handling just war / jihād (striving in the path of God) / dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits). Compare criteria, mark contested items [SOURCE CAUTION], and name the internal counter-traditions (Kauṭilya's kūṭa-yuddha (deceptive or irregular warfare); contested modern readings).



9. [SOURCE CAUTION] Do not assert the "greater/lesser jihād (striving in the path of God)" distinction as canonical. Its supporting report is disputed by ḥadīth scholars — cite it with the flag.

11. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not read the Gītā as a general theory of war. Kṛṣṇa's argument is svadharma (one's own role-specific duty) within a narrative situation; Gandhi's allegorical reading is one influential interpretation, not the plain sense.

13. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] In "why be moral", separate justification from motivation — the printed claim is weak on the first and strong on the second, and saying so is the answer.

15. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not treat Nietzsche's genealogy as a refutation. Origin does not settle validity; his target is the value of the valuation, and Scheler's Ressentiment is the named counter-authority.

10. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not treat dār al-islām (abode of Islam)/dār al-ḥarb (abode of war) as Qur'ānic. They are juristic-historical constructs whose contemporary application is contested within the tradition.

12. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] In the 2018 "religiosity and immorality" stem, keep the printed word and use the intrinsic/extrinsic/quest apparatus. The verdict is conditional ambivalence, not a correlation.

14. [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Do not present modified DCT as defeating Euthyphro outright. It blocks arbitrariness but concedes that "loving/good" is a concept we grasp independently.

13. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

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Keywords: [FACT] divine command · modified command theory (Adams) · divine motivation theory (Zagzebski) · Alston's standard reply · Euthyphro · arbitrariness · autonomy · heteronomy · categorical imperative · universal law · humanity as end · natural law · moral realism · justification vs motivation · Ring of Gyges · Hobbes' Foole · sensible knave · Bradley's "why should I be moral?" · constrained maximisation · eudaimonism · moral licensing · scrupulosity · intrinsic/extrinsic/quest religiosity · prophetic critique · teleological suspension of the ethical · jus ad bellum/jus in bello/jus post bellum · discrimination · proportionality · legitimate authority · qitāl (armed fighting) ·

CONTINUATION 2/3

jihād al-nafs (struggle against the lower self) [SOURCE CAUTION] · dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits) · kūṭa-yuddha (deceptive or irregular warfare) · sāma-dāna-bheda-daṇḍa · compelle intrare · Locke on the incoercibility of belief · dharma (moral-religious duty and order) · ṛta (cosmic order) · karma (action and moral causation) · ahimsā (non-violence) · aṇuvrata (limited Jain vow)/mahāvratā (great Jain vow) · anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) as intellectual non-violence · cetanā · brahmavihāra (sublime meditative abode) · ownerless suffering (Śāntideva) · niṣkāma-karma (action without attachment to results) · codanā (Vedic injunction) · slave

CONTINUATION 3/3

morality · resentment · ascetic ideal · bad conscience · revaluation · Übermensch · amor fati · eternal recurrence · nihilism.

Safe formulations: [INFERENCE / CAUTION] "God-reference may strengthen motivation without constituting obligation." · "Religion and morality are conceptually distinguishable, historically interactive and normatively mutually critical." · "Religion's distinctive contribution to the ethics of force is restraint, not licence." · "Religiosity is an amplifier: it magnifies the moral content it is attached to." · "Secular ethics answers the justificatory question; the printed doubt bites only on motivation in the undetected case."

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit)

- [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Priority: Primary ownership is 11 of 112 parts, including three distinct demands in 2019.

- [FACT] Required doctrinal depth: Older questions add the printed religiosity–“immorality” relation, religious violence, conflict with social morality, secular motivation, compatibility of belief/practice with conduct and inseparability claims.



- ? Trap / answer consequence: Do not reduce the debate to Divine Command Theory; distinguish conceptual dependence, epistemic grounding, motivational force and actual sociological influence.

14. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Corpus signal: 11 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

2018	Q5(d)	10 marks	Can one claim that there is an inter-relatedness between ‘religiosity’ and ‘immorality’? Discuss. [SOURCE CAUTION] The held paper visibly prints “immorality”; it is retained rather than silently regularised to “morality”.
2019	Q5(c)	10 marks	Can there be a philosophical argument to support violence in the name of religion? Discuss.
2019	Q5(d)	10 marks	Does a devoted commitment to a religious way of life make man go astray from social morality? Examine.

2019	Q7(b)	15 marks	Secular ethics cannot fully resolve as to why one should be moral all the time. Examine.
2020	Q8(b)	15 marks	Are religious beliefs and practices incompatible with moral behaviour? Discuss.
2021	Q6(c)	15 marks	Do you consider that religion and morality are inseparable? Give reasons for your answer.
2022	Q5(b)	10 marks	"One can have morality without religion but not religion without morality." Discuss.
2023	Q5(c)	10 marks	Does religion influence the moral behaviour? Explain the interactive relation between religion and morality.
2024	Q5(a)	10 marks	Can there be a religion without morality? Discuss.
2025	Q5(c)	10 marks	Present an account of Nietzsche's criticism of religion and morality.
2025	Q8(b)	15 marks	Is it necessary for the normative principles to bear reference to God in order to produce a feeling of obligation in a moral agent? Critically discuss.

See the Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

15. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 MARKS)

10 marks

State dependence claim → Euthyphro/Kant discriminator → one Indian illustration → distinguish grounding from motivation → verdict.

15 marks

Frame obligation problem → strongest theistic account → autonomy/natural-law rival → objection and reply → interaction analysis → defended conclusion.

20 marks

Separate rightness, obligation and motivation → compare command, autonomy and dharma (moral-religious duty and order)
→
Euthyphro plus immoral-religion objections → replies → graded relational thesis.

16. DIRECTIVE DECODER

Can one claim that there is an inter-relatedness between A and B?	A conditional verdict, with the condition named	Neither "yes" nor "no": say under what conditions	2018 Q5(d) religiosity/immorality
Can there be a philosophical argument to support X?	Candidate arguments in premises, then the failing premise	Never a historical survey	2019 Q5(c)
Does X make man go astray from Y? Examine	Test of a causal/normative claim	Distinguish the disposition from the system; use intrinsic/extrinsic	2019 Q5(d)
[Claim]. Examine	Fidelity to the claim's exact scope	"All the time" is the operative phrase — build the answer on it	2019 Q7(b)
Are A and B incompatible? Discuss	An incompatibility claim tested, not a survey	One clear counter-case defeats a necessity claim	2020 Q8(b)
Do you consider that A and B are inseparable? Give reasons	A first-person verdict with ranked reasons	Separability must be shown by an actual system, not asserted	2021 Q6(c)
"Quotation." Discuss	The quotation's asymmetry analysed in both directions	Test each direction separately	2022 Q5(b)
Does A influence B? Explain the interactive relation	Two deliverables — influence and the interaction model	Causal influence ≠ logical dependence	2023 Q5(c)
Present an account of X's criticism of A and B	Both objects, and their connection in X's system	Nietzsche's two halves are one argument — show the link	2025 Q5(c)
Is it necessary for X to bear reference to Y...? Critically discuss	A necessity claim tested	Distinguish grounding, epistemic access and motivation	2025 Q8(b)

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

[MNEMONIC] Rule: in this clause almost every stem is a claim of necessity, dependence or incompatibility. Your first move is always to ask which relation is asserted — conceptual dependence, epistemic dependence, motivational dependence, or sociological correlation — because they have four different answers.

17. GRADED VERDICT LADDER

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion and morality are conceptually distinguishable, historically interactive and normatively mutually critical; religion may strengthen moral life without monopolising moral truth.

Weak (≈40%)	"Religion teaches morality"; DCT and Kant named	The four kinds of dependence merged
Average (≈50%)	Euthyphro stated with both horns; Kantian autonomy	Indian material limited to one line on dharma (moral-religious duty and order)
Good (≈60%)	Grounding vs motivation separated; one objection answered	Modified DCT absent; non-theistic groundings asserted, not argued
Strong (≈65–70%)	Modified DCT and its residual objection; a real non-theistic grounding argued (Śāntideva, Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school)); interaction analysed	Verdict summarises rather than decides
Top (≈70%+)	All the above + a discriminating distinction (semantic/metaphysical/motivational dependence; intrinsic vs extrinsic religiosity; justification vs motivation; restraint vs licence) + the concession that costs the writer's own position something	—

Graded-verdict templates:

- [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Asymmetry stem: "The asymmetry holds, but for a reason the slogan hides: morality is constitutive of what we are willing to call a religion, whereas religion is at most supportive of morality. Constitutive and supportive relations are not two degrees of one relation."

- [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Dependence stem: "Morality is not conceptually dependent on religion — the Euthyphro shows that, and four independent non-theistic groundings confirm it. It may be motivationally and historically dependent for many agents, and those are different claims that a good answer keeps apart."



- [INFERENCE / CAUTION] Violence stem: "No sound argument survives. Each candidate is valid in form and fails at a premise — the identification of the divine will, the vulnerability of the sacred, the efficacy of coercion, or the total evil of the adversary."

18. FACTUAL AND QUOTATION DISCIPLINE

Euthyphro dilemma	[FACT] Plato, Euthyphro 10a	State both horns

"If God does not exist, everything is permitted"	[SOURCE CAUTION] A summary of a Dostoevskian theme, not a verified verbatim line	Never present as a quotation
Finite and Infinite Goods	[FACT] Robert Merrihew Adams (1999)	Modified DCT: obligation from a loving God's commands; goodness from resemblance to God
The "standard metre" reply to Euthyphro	[FACT] William Alston	God as the supreme standard, not a conformer
"Does Moral Philosophy Rest on a Mistake?"	[FACT] H. A. Prichard (Mind, 1912)	Pairs with Bradley's Essay II
Ring of Gyges	[FACT] Plato, Republic II 359d–360b	The canonical statement of the "all the time" problem
Hume's sensible knave	[FACT] Enquiry Concerning the Principles of Morals, IX.ii	Hume's own difficulty, honestly admitted
Intrinsic/extrinsic religiosity	[FACT] Gordon Allport; quest orientation [FACT] Daniel Batson	The apparatus for the 2018 stem
Ressentiment (the critique of Nietzsche)	[FACT] Max Scheler (1912)	Christian love from abundance, not impotence
Gay Science §125; Genealogy I–III; BGE Preface	[FACT] Verified locations	Paraphrase the rhetoric; quote sparingly
Aquinas' three war conditions	[FACT] ST II-II q.40	Authority, just cause, right intention
Just and Unjust Wars	[FACT] Michael Walzer (1977)	Modern ad bellum/in bello systematisation
"Greater/lesser jihād (striving in the path of God)"	[SOURCE CAUTION] Report of disputed authenticity among ḥadīth scholars	Cite with the flag; never as settled doctrine
Dār al-islām (abode of Islam)/dār al-ḥarb (abode of war)	[INFERENCE / CAUTION] Juristic-historical constructs, not Qurʾānic terms	Say so explicitly
Dharma-yuddha (righteous war governed by moral limits) rules	[FACT] Mahābhārata (Śānti-/Anuśāsana-parvan) and Dharmaśāstra	Give the protected categories; then the internal tension
Kūṭa-yuddha (deceptive or irregular warfare)	[FACT] Kauṭilya's Arthaśāstra	The Indian realist counter-tradition
Compelle intrare (Luke 14:23)	[FACT] Augustine's Donatist-controversy use	Examined as a position, never endorsed
Locke on the incoercibility of belief	[FACT] A Letter Concerning Toleration (1689)	The decisive refutation of soteriological coercion
Śāntideva on ownerless suffering	[FACT] Bodhicaryāvatāra (Guide to the Bodhisattva's Way of Life), ch. VIII	The strongest non-theistic grounding of impartial altruism
Gītā 2.3 (klaibya), 2.42–43, 2.47, 3.19	[FACT] Verified chapter/verse	Paraphrase translations

19. LINK-OUTS

- Religion without God — non-theistic religion; Nietzsche's PYQ is routed here, not there

- Religious Pluralism — tolerance, religious freedom and the conflict-history question



- Problem of Evil — desert, victim-blaming and the ethics of theodicy

- Soul, Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation — karma (action and moral causation) as the exhaustive moral order; niṣkāma-karma (action without attachment to results)

- Paper I: Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school) — duty from injunction without a commander

- Paper I: Jainism — ahiṃsā (non-violence), aṇuvrata (limited Jain vow)/mahāvratā (great Jain vow), anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality)

- Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018–2025

- Notions of God — divine goodness, simplicity and the Euthyphro's target

- Paper I: Kant — autonomy, heteronomy, the categorical imperative

- Paper I: Buddhism — cetanā, brahmavihāras (four sublime meditative abodes), Śāntideva

- Paper II: Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism

SOURCES

- Plato, Euthyphro and Republic II; Immanuel Kant, Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals and Religion within the Bounds of Bare Reason.

- Friedrich Nietzsche, The Gay Science, On the Genealogy of Morality, Beyond Good and Evil, Thus Spoke Zarathustra; Max Scheler, Ressentiment.

- Thomas Aquinas, Summa Theologiae II-II q.40; Michael Walzer, Just and Unjust Wars; John Locke, A Letter Concerning Toleration.

- Robert Merrihew Adams, Finite and Infinite Goods; Linda Zagzebski, Divine Motivation Theory; William Alston, "Some Suggestions for Divine Command Theorists".

- David Hume, An Enquiry Concerning the Principles of Morals; F. H. Bradley, Ethical Studies; H. A. Prichard, "Does Moral Philosophy Rest on a Mistake?"; David Gauthier, Morals by Agreement.

- Śāntideva, Bodhicaryāvatāra (Guide to the Bodhisattva's Way of Life); Kauṭilya, Arthaśāstra; Mahābhārata, Śānti-parvan.

- Gordon Allport and Daniel Batson on religious orientation.

- William J. Wainwright (ed.), The Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion; John Hick, Philosophy of Religion.



- Bhagavad Gītā and Indian ethics discussions in S. C. Chatterjee & D. M. Datta and C. D. Sharma.

PYQ ROUTES + ANSWER SPINES

FULL MODEL PROSE NOT DUPLICATED

HOW TO READ THESE ROUTES

Route discipline: question → directive/demand → named evidence → objection/reply → bounded verdict. Each card preserves the source-owned demand decoder and its explicit marks-earning criteria.

2018 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Can one claim that there is an inter-relatedness between 'religiosity' and 'immorality'? Discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: Define religiosity; test a conditional correlation with immorality; distinguish orientations of religiosity; give arguments on both sides; reach neither a mechanical "yes" nor "no".

SCORING SPINE: Preserves and explains the printed word "immorality". • Distinguishes religion from religiosity before assessing correlation. • Uses Allport's intrinsic/extrinsic and Batson's quest apparatus. • Gives internal Indian and prophetic critiques rather than attacking a community. • Ends with a precise conditional-amplifier verdict.

2019 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Can there be a philosophical argument to support violence in the name of religion? Discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: This is not a history-of-conflicts question. State candidate arguments in premise-conclusion form, identify the failing premise, distinguish religious licence from ordinary defensive force, and conclude on soundness.

SCORING SPINE: Answers the philosophical structure rather than narrating conflicts. • Tests four arguments and pinpoints defective premises. • Uses Kierkegaard, Locke, Euthyphro and Gandhi accurately. • Separates defensive force from a religious licence. • Maintains community-neutral language.



2019 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Does a devoted commitment to a religious way of life make man go astray from social morality? Examine.

DEMAND ROUTE: Test a causal and normative claim, not merely describe religion. Distinguish devoted commitment from its orientation, show possible conflict and reinforcement, and deliver a qualified verdict.

SCORING SPINE: Directly tests "make man go astray". • Uses the suspension argument without treating it as a general licence. • Applies intrinsic/extrinsic/quest religiosity. • Includes a balanced Indian dharma (moral-religious duty and order) example. • Gives clear conditions for both deviation and reinforcement.

2019 · Q7(b) · 15 marks

QUESTION: Secular ethics cannot fully resolve as to why one should be moral all the time. Examine.

DEMAND ROUTE: Put weight on "all the time": costly, undetected and unreciprocated conduct. Separate justification from motivation; assess several secular and religious answers; avoid claiming that secular ethics cannot ground morality.

SCORING SPINE: Makes "all the time" the organising problem. • Separates justification from motivation throughout. • Compares Kant, contractarianism, virtue ethics and sentimentalism. • Uses Gyges, the Foole and sensible knave accurately. • Gives karma (action and moral causation) and niskama-karma a real argumentative role. • Concedes costs on both secular and religious sides.

2020 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

QUESTION: Are religious beliefs and practices incompatible with moral behaviour? Discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: Test a universal incompatibility claim. Define the terms, present apparent conflicts, show counter-cases, distinguish logical, motivational and sociological relations, and decide whether incompatibility is necessary or contingent.

SCORING SPINE: Refutes a necessity claim by conceptual analysis and counter-examples. • States both Euthyphro horns correctly. • Distinguishes conceptual, motivational and sociological relations. • Integrates Indian ethical practices without romanticising them. • Includes modified DCT and its residual objection. • Delivers a criterion-based conclusion.

2022 · Q5(b) · 10 marks

QUESTION: "One can have morality without religion but not religion without morality." Discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: Analyse the quotation's asymmetry by testing each direction separately. Explain different kinds of dependence and avoid reducing "religion without morality" to the empirical existence of corrupt institutions.

SCORING SPINE: Tests both halves of the quotation independently. • Uses Kant, Euthyphro and Indian non-theistic ethics. • Distinguishes descriptive institutions from worthy religion. • Separates constitutive dependence from motivational support. • Reaches a qualified rather than rhetorical conclusion.

2024 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Can there be a religion without morality? Discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: Clarify whether "can" is descriptive or normative. Show that an institution may exist with rituals yet fail as worthy religion; explain why ethics is internally required without claiming that religion creates all morality.

SCORING SPINE: Makes the decisive descriptive/normative distinction. • Uses internal critiques from more than one tradition. • Avoids reversing the dependence claim. • Separates moral justification from religious motivation. • Gives an exact answer to "can there be".

2021 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

QUESTION: Do you consider that religion and morality are inseparable? Give reasons for your answer.

DEMAND ROUTE: Give a defended personal verdict. Test separability in both directions with actual systems, not slogans; distinguish descriptive religion from normatively worthy religion; retain interaction after rejecting strict dependence.

SCORING SPINE: Announces and defends a clear first-person verdict. • Tests both directions of alleged inseparability. • Argues from four non-theistic groundings. • Evaluates rather than merely names modified DCT. • Distinguishes descriptive existence from normative adequacy. • Preserves reciprocal interaction after establishing autonomy.

2023 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Does religion influence the moral behaviour? Explain the interactive relation between religion and morality.

DEMAND ROUTE: Complete both tasks: explain causal influence on conduct and show reciprocal interaction. Do not infer truth or logical dependence from sociological influence.

SCORING SPINE: Answers both "influence" and "interactive relation". • Separates causal influence from logical dependence. • Gives mechanisms rather than a generic harmony claim. • Uses India-aware examples and religiosity orientations. • Shows morality's reformatory influence on religion.

2025 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

QUESTION: Present an account of Nietzsche's criticism of religion and morality.

DEMAND ROUTE: Explain both religion and morality as two parts of one genealogy. Treat "God is dead" as cultural diagnosis, cover ressentiment, guilt and ascetic ideal, state the positive programme, and evaluate.

SCORING SPINE: Connects the death of God to the genealogy of morality. • Accurately covers all three essays of the Genealogy. • Does not mistake nihilism for Nietzsche's goal. • Names the genetic-fallacy objection and Scheler. • Balances lasting diagnosis against constructive weakness.

2025 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

QUESTION: Is it necessary for the normative principles to bear reference to God in order to produce a feeling of obligation in a moral agent? Critically discuss.

DEMAND ROUTE: Test necessity, not mere usefulness. Distinguish the ground and content of obligation, epistemic access to norms, and the production of motivational feeling. Present the strongest theistic account, non-theistic counter-examples, objections and a graded conclusion.

SCORING SPINE: Splits metaphysical, epistemic and motivational dependence. • Presents strong and modified DCT charitably. • States modified DCT’s residual conceptual objection. • Argues, rather than asserts, multiple non-theistic groundings. • Treats “feeling of obligation” as motivation without reducing normativity to feeling. • Reaches a graded verdict directly on necessity.

Original 2 · 10 marks

QUESTION: Can moral criticism of religion be internal to religion itself? Discuss with Indian illustrations.

DEMAND ROUTE: Explain internal criticism; show how ethical resources within traditions challenge practice; use India-aware examples; avoid assuming either total autonomy or institutional infallibility.

SCORING SPINE: Defines internal criticism clearly. • Uses several precise Indian illustrations. • Explains both reformatory strength and interpretive limits. • Avoids romanticising traditions. • Offers a balanced internal-public reason model.

Original 4 · 15 marks

QUESTION: “Religiosity is morally ambivalent, not morally neutral.” Analyse using the intrinsic, extrinsic and quest orientations.

DEMAND ROUTE: Explain why religiosity has effects without one fixed moral direction; apply all three orientations; integrate ritual substitution, group identity and reform; reach a conditional causal verdict.

SCORING SPINE: Distinguishes ambivalence from neutrality. • Applies intrinsic, extrinsic and quest orientations separately. • Explains causal mechanisms instead of asserting correlation. • Includes internal Indian critiques and constructive practices. • Names conditions producing both immorality and reform. • Avoids treating religiosity as the unique source of social harm.

Original 1 · 10 marks

QUESTION: “Religious motivation may strengthen moral compliance without grounding moral obligation.” Explain and evaluate.

DEMAND ROUTE: Distinguish motivation from metaphysical or justificatory grounding; show how religion can strengthen conduct; test whether such motivation has moral costs; give a graded verdict.

SCORING SPINE: Defines grounding and motivation separately. • Uses Kant and Euthyphro as discriminators. • Gives karma (action and moral causation) and niskama-karma analytical roles. • Concedes heteronomy and belief-dependence. • Ends with a precise sufficient/necessary verdict.

Original 3 · 15 marks

QUESTION: Critically examine whether modified Divine Command Theory escapes the Euthyphro dilemma.

DEMAND ROUTE: State both horns; reconstruct Adams’s and Alston’s refinements; identify what they solve and what remains; compare with rival groundings; give a reasoned verdict rather than declaring victory or failure.

SCORING SPINE: States both horns before evaluating replies. • Accurately distinguishes Adams’s obligation/goodness claims. • Includes Alston’s standard reply without overclaiming. • Identifies conceptual circularity and epistemic access. • Tests the theory against actual non-theistic groundings. • Gives a nuanced partial-success verdict.

Original 5 · 20 marks

QUESTION: Are morality’s content, authority and motivational force equally dependent on religion? Critically discuss with reference to Western and Indian traditions.

DEMAND ROUTE: Separate three dependence claims; compare strongest religious and autonomous accounts; use Western and Indian arguments at parity; evaluate objections; defend a graded relational thesis.

SCORING SPINE: Organises the answer around three distinct dependence claims. • Gives modified DCT and natural law their strongest versions. • Uses Kant, Buddhism, Jainism and Mimamsa as argued alternatives. • Gives karma (action and moral causation) and niskama-karma a precise motivational function. • Integrates religiosity orientation and reciprocal reform. • Concedes weaknesses in both religious and secular positions.

Original 6 · 20 marks

QUESTION: "Religion's distinctive contribution to the ethics of force is restraint, not licence." Examine philosophically and comparatively.

DEMAND ROUTE: Reconstruct and test arguments for religious violence; distinguish them from ordinary defensive force; compare restraint criteria across traditions without adjudicating communities; address internal counter-traditions; deliver a soundness verdict.

SCORING SPINE: Treats the issue as normative justification, not conflict history. • Reconstructs four arguments and identifies exact premise failures. • Uses Locke, Kierkegaard, Euthyphro and Gandhi accurately. • Compares three restraint frameworks by shared criteria. • Flags disputed claims and internal realist counter-traditions. • Separates ordinary defensive force from religious licence.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

FINAL RAPID-RETRIEVAL FLOW

A. Four relations

Conceptual/metaphysical	Does morality exist because of God?	Euthyphro
Epistemic	Is revelation needed to know duty?	access differs from truth
Motivational	Why obey when costly and unseen?	motivation differs from justification
Sociological	Does religion improve conduct?	correlation is conditional

B. Divine command theory

- Rightness or obligation is constituted by divine command.

- Distinguish semantic, metaphysical and motivational dependence.

- Strength: authority, unity, accountability and motivational seriousness.

- Costs: arbitrariness, access to commands and heteronomy.

C. Euthyphro and modified DCT

- Good because commanded -> apparently arbitrary.

- Residual objection: "loving" already carries moral content.

- Commanded because good -> goodness appears independent.

- Adams: obligation from commands of a necessarily loving God; goodness resembles divine nature.

D. Kant and natural law

- Kant: autonomy is rational self-legislation under universal law, not preference.

- Its difficulty is the nature-to-norm transition.

- Fear of punishment may secure conformity without moral worth.

- Natural law: objective goods are rationally accessible within a divinely grounded order.

E. Indian grounding

- Dharma (moral-religious duty and order) unites normative, ritual, social and soteriological dimensions but is not identical with universal morality.

- Buddhism uses intention, suffering and compassion; Jainism uses ahimsā (non-violence), vows and intellectual non-violence.

- Karma (action and moral causation) makes conduct causally exhaustive; niškāma-karma (action without attachment to results) removes fruit from deliberation.

- Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school) derives duty from Vedic injunction without a personal commander.

F. Why be moral all the time?

- Gyges, Hobbes's Foole and Hume's sensible knave isolate costly, undetected conduct.

- Sanction solves motivation at the possible cost of heteronomy.

- Secular theories can justify norms; motivation may still fail.

- Religion adds sanction, love, karma (action and moral causation) or cosmic integration.

G. Religion without morality

- Descriptively, institutions may preserve ritual while acting unjustly.

- Normatively, a religion wholly without moral concern is self-corrupting.

- The 2022 asymmetry: morality without religion is possible; worthy religion without morality is not.

H. Religiosity and conduct

- Intrinsic religiosity treats faith as an end; extrinsic uses it instrumentally; quest remains open and reflective.

- Keep the printed 2018 word "immorality."

- Religiosity is an amplifier, not automatically virtue.

- Prophetic and reform traditions show internal moral criticism.

I. Religious violence

- State candidate arguments in premises, then identify the failing premise.

- What survives is ordinary defensive-force permission, not a special religious licence.

- Divine-command violence fails on fallible access to the alleged command.

- Coercion-for-salvation fails because force compels profession, not belief.

J. Nietzsche

- "God is dead" is a cultural diagnosis.

- Slave morality emerges through ressentiment and inversion.

- Guilt develops from debt; the ascetic ideal gives suffering meaning.

- Revaluation, self-overcoming and affirmation are constructive aims.

- Objections: genetic fallacy, missing criterion and caricature of Christian love.

K. Eleven PYQ routes

2018: conditional relation between religiosity and printed "immorality." 2019: violence argument; social morality; "all the time" motivation. 2020: compatibility of belief/practice and moral conduct. 2021: test inseparability through actual counterexamples. 2022: analyse the slogan's two directions separately. 2023: influence plus reciprocal interaction. 2024: descriptive possibility versus normative adequacy of religion without morality. 2025: Nietzsche's linked critique; necessity of God-reference for obligation.

L. Final answer discipline

1. Identify the exact relation asserted.

2. Define religion and morality only as needed.

3. Present the strongest dependence argument.

4. Apply Euthyphro or the appropriate discriminator.

5. Add one genuine non-theistic grounding.

6. Separate justification, motivation and influence.

7. Concede religion's distinctive contribution.

8. Give a graded verdict, not "both are related."

KEY VERDICT / MNEMONIC

Final judgement: Religion and morality are conceptually distinguishable, historically interactive and normatively mutually critical. God-reference may strengthen motivation and cosmic significance without being necessary for moral obligation.

LAST-MINUTE ANSWER CHECK

Final check before writing: definition controlled; rival positions distinguished; named thinkers/traditions used accurately; strongest objection faced; reply cost admitted; PYQ directive obeyed; conclusion bounded.